

HCS Website — Per-Page Build Plan

Heron Constructive Solutions Ltd — derived from the Website Design Brief

Prepared 6 August 2026 · Internal working plan

Context. HCS is an external works & landscaping contractor for housing associations and councils (Plus Dane, Knowsley). Per the brief, the site's job is to pass procurement due-diligence: it must be **evidence, not advertising** — real projects, real partners, real accreditations, zero placeholders.

Today the codebase is a Tailwind/EJS scaffold still carrying template junk: lorem ipsum, fake stats (500+ / 200+ / 10+), SaaS boilerplate, `placeholder.co` images, ecommerce alt text, US placeholder contact details, and dead `#` links. This plan fixes the site **page by page**, matching the brief's 6-step launch sequence.

Working approach. Build correct structure everywhere; where a real fact is missing, insert a clearly-marked **[TO SUPPLY]** note — never invent stats, quotes, team members, or project claims. Scope = every page/route.

Brand invariants. Maroon `#8B2332`, green `#3D8B37`, charcoal `#404040`. Contact source of truth in `services/pageService.js`: Heron Constructive Solutions LTD · 0151 475 1217 · info@heroncs.co.uk · 103 Herondale Road, Mossley Hill, Liverpool L18 1JZ.

Phase 0 — Site-wide fixes (do first; touches every page)

- 0.1 Fix config bug: `facebookHHandle` → `facebookHandle` in `pageService.js` (footer FB link is currently broken).
- 0.2 Verify the **Cheshire office** (456 Kingfisher Lane...) — looks like dummy data. **[TO SUPPLY]** real second office or remove.
- 0.3 Fix duplicate `</body></html>` — present in both `layout.ejs` and `footer.ejs`. Keep one.
- 0.4 De-hotlink the logo: `header.ejs` & `footer.ejs` use `https://heroncs.co.uk/images/...` → change to local `/images/HCS-Logo-v5.png`.
- 0.5 Add the **missing favicon assets** referenced in `head.ejs`, or remove the tags. **[TO SUPPLY]** favicon source or derive from logo.
- 0.6 Fix Windows backslash image paths (`images\fence...`) → forward slashes site-wide (breaks on Linux hosts). Mainly `services.ejs`.
- 0.7 Image optimisation pass: 15 files exceed the 300KB limit, incl. two ~1MB stock `_1920` files. Re-export real photos web-sized; **delete the 3 stock images** (brief forbids stock). Shrink Living wage LOGO.png (321KB).

Phase 1 — Footer (shared, high-visibility) → `views/partials/footer.ejs`

- 1.1 Replace the joke tagline with a one-line real positioning statement.

- 1.2 Add **full contact block** (brief SEO #2): company name, Liverpool address, phone, email — from `site.liverpool.*`.
- 1.3 Fix Services column dead links: Fences → `/fencing`; others → real service pages once built (Phase 8), else remove.
- 1.4 Fix Legal column: Privacy → `/privacy`, remove Terms/License `#` links. Remove "Socials" link.
- 1.5 Confirm FB/IG/X links resolve after 0.1; hide any whose env handle is empty.

Phase 2 — Home (real) → views/pages/home.ejs

Homepage leads with named partners, social value (Jobs Plus), and the 3 strongest before/after pairs.

- 2.1 Hero: rewrite H1 to external-works positioning. Replace dead "Get started"/"Learn more" with real CTAs → `/studies` and `/contact`.
- 2.2 Fix hero image `alt="App screenshot"` → real description of the photo.
- 2.3 Keep Plus Dane / Knowsley logos; label section "Approved contractor for". Fix `alt="need logo"`.
- 2.4 *(Deferred — moved to Phase 5A.)* The "Story" block becomes the **Jobs Plus / social value** panel. Needs real Jobs Plus content. Until then, don't ship the lorem.
- 2.5 Replace the **Case Studies** block: `placeholder.co`, "case study 2/3", clothing alt, `#` links → 3 real before/after pairs → `/studies`. **[TO SUPPLY]** project headers/facts.

Phase 2B — Home cleanup & polish (moved from Phase 2) → home.ejs

- 2B.1 Delete the "Boost your productivity. Start using our app today." CTA section — replace with a single "Discuss your estate programme" → `/contact`.
- 2B.2 Carousel: give real alt text (currently "First/Second slide").
- 2B.3 Fix stray `</main> / </div>` nesting bug.
- 2B.4 Set a real meta description in `pageService.js`.

Phase 3 — About → views/pages/about.ejs

About is "credibility poison" right now (lorem + fake stats). Highest-priority content rewrite.

- 3.1 Keep H1 "Why Choose Us" intro. Replace 4× `placeholder.co` hero grid with real photos + alt text.
- 3.2 Replace the six Tailwind "Our values" cards (Be world-class / ... / Enjoy downtime) with real HCS values. `[TO SUPPLY]` values copy.
- 3.3 Add the required **Accreditations & compliance** section (Constructionline / CHAS / SafeContractor / SMAS / CITB), insurance, H&S. First thing procurement looks for. `[TO SUPPLY]` membership numbers/insurance.
- 3.4 Add **"How we work on your estate"** section: resident liaison, DBS-checked & badged operatives, tidy sites, complaints handling. `[TO SUPPLY]` specifics.
- 3.5 Team section: placeholder people + `placeholder.co`. Either `[TO SUPPLY]` real team or remove the section.
- 3.6 Remove the "From the blog" block (Latin titles + `#` links), or wire to real `/blog`.
- 3.7 Replace shared Case Studies placeholder block (as 2.5). Fix self-closing `<div>` / `<main>` nesting bug.
- 3.8 Real meta description in `pageService.js`.

Phase 4 — Contact → views/pages/contact.ejs

Contact details identical everywhere. This page currently shows US fake data — highest-priority factual error.

- 4.1 Replace address "545 Mavis Island, Chicago, IL 99191" → real Liverpool address (from `site.liverpool`).
- 4.2 Replace phone "+1 (555) 234-5678" → `0151 475 1217` (fix `tel:` too).
- 4.3 Add an **H1** (page has none — top is H2 "Get in touch").
- 4.4 Fix the form: `action="#"` → `action="/contact" method="POST"` (route already exists). Wire sent/error/form states the controller passes.
- 4.5 `[TO SUPPLY]` decision on whether the contact form should actually email (currently a stub).

Phase 5 — Case Studies / Studies → views/pages/studies.ejs

The project-story library — the core proof asset. Format: header (client+location+scope), before photo + problem, after photo (identical angle), three facts, optional quote.

- 5.1 Remove **fake stats** "500+ / 200+ / 10+". Replace with real figures or delete. `[TO SUPPLY]` real numbers.
- 5.2 Replace 4× `placeholder.co` hero grid with real photos + alt.
- 5.3 Build a reusable **project-story component** in the brief's format. Populate the one real story (Plus Dane Housing) with real before/after images.
- 5.4 Remove the two template articles ("How to use SEO to drive sales" / "Improve your customer experience").
- 5.5 Prioritise one **estate-scale** story ("47 gardens re-fenced..." style). `[TO SUPPLY]` estate story facts/photos.
- 5.6 Fix stray `</article>` / `</div>` nesting bug. Real meta description.

Phase 5A — Jobs Plus / social value (deferred content)

Depends on real Jobs Plus / Travis Perkins content not yet ready; same social-value story as the estate case study (5.5). The homepage panel is the priority.

5A.1 Home "Story" band → **Jobs Plus / social value** panel. Reuse the existing two-column band — keep layout/styling, swap contents:

- Heading "Our story" → e.g. "Social value: our Jobs Plus partnership".
- Body: replace lorem with a plain-English explanation of what Jobs Plus delivers locally. [TO SUPPLY]
- Image: `placeholder.co` → real on-site "during" shot (branded PPE, tidy site). [TO SUPPLY]
- Link: point to a real Jobs Plus case study on `/studies`, or remove — never leave `#`.

5A.2 Ensure the Jobs Plus story also appears as a case study on `/studies` (ties to 5.5).

Phase 6 — Services (hub) → views/pages/content/services.ejs

- 6.1 Fill the **empty intro paragraph** under the H1. Rewrite H1 in tender vocabulary if needed.
- 6.2 Fix the product-card grid: ecommerce alt text & nonsense sub-labels → real service names/descriptions. Point each card to its real service page (Phase 8); remove `#` links for services not yet built.
- 6.3 Replace `placeholder.co` service images with real photos, or drop cards for services without photos.
- 6.4 Delete the "heat-death of the universe" featured block or replace with a real "our approach" panel; fix "Read our story" → `#`.
- 6.5 Replace shared Case Studies placeholder block (as 2.5).
- 6.6 Fix backslash image paths (0.6). Meta description already OK-ish.

Phase 7 — Fencing (service template) → views/pages/content/fencing.ejs

Strong page already (real copy). Fixes only:

- 7.1 Add the missing `id="contact"` target (or point the hero "Request a Free Quote" CTA to `/contact`) — currently a dead anchor.
- 7.2 Replace `placeholder.co` images (wood/vinyl + 4× gallery) with real fence photos. Alt text here is already good — keep it.
- 7.3 Rename toward the SEO title "Fencing & Gates for Housing Associations"; confirm intended URL (`canonicalUrl` is `/fencing` while `activeNav` is `/services`).

Phase 8 — Split Services into one-page-per-service (brief SEO #1)

Separate, search-named pages: fencing & gates · communal area improvements · paths & paving · estate improvements · accessibility works. Fencing is the working template.

- 8.1 For each service: add route + controller fn + view-model fn + view. **Recommendation:** refactor to a config-driven service list (one array of `{slug, title, description, images}`) instead of 5 hand-copied files.
- 8.2 Each page: unique title "<Service> for Housing Associations | Heron Constructive Solutions", one H1, place names, one real before/after pair, alt on every image. **[TO SUPPLY]** per-service copy + photos.
- 8.3 Update footer (1.3) and services hub (6.2) links once pages exist.

Phase 9 — Blog → views/pages/blog/index.ejs + post.ejs

- 9.1 Templates are clean and data-driven. Posts are in-memory placeholders. Decide: keep a light "news" section or hide `/blog` until there's real content. **[TO SUPPLY]** real posts or a hide decision.

Phase 10 — Utility pages & dead templates

- 10.1 `privacy.ejs` — clean; just link it from the footer (1.4). Confirm "Last updated" date.
- 10.2 `404.ejs` + `error.ejs` — clean, keep.

10.3 Delete unused demo templates: `views/home.ejs` (Pied Piper / lorem ecommerce demo — the live home is `pages/home.ejs`) and `services by category/browse.ejs` (unmodified "Machined Pen \$35" demo, not routed). Confirm neither is referenced before deleting.

SEO & accessibility pass (apply as each page is built)

- **Unique page titles** per route (pattern already correct — just supply distinct title/description).
- **One H1 per page** — add to contact, browse (if kept); fix empty intros.
- **Alt text on every image** — no image ships without a real one-line description.
- **Place names** — Liverpool, Knowsley, Merseyside, North West — in body copy and every case study.
- **Contrast/WCAG** — check light-grey-on-white; verify maroon-on-white passes (it does).
- **Mobile-first** — test each page at phone/tablet/desktop.
- **Lean photos** — <300KB (Phase 0.7).

Verification

- Run `npm run css:build` then `npm run dev` — boots on the configured port.
- Visit every route: `/`, `/about`, `/studies`, `/contact`, `/services`, `/fencing`, `/privacy`, `/blog`, each new service page, a bad URL (404), `/sitemap.xml`, `/robots.txt`.
- **Grep gates** (must return zero): `placeholder.co`, `lorem ipsum`, `Get started`, `App screenshot`, `need logo`, `case study 2`, `500+`, `Mavis Island`, `555) 234`, `heat-death`, `Enjoy downtime`, `href="#"`.
- Submit the contact form → confirm `/contact?sent=1` and the success state render.
- Check every nav/footer/CTA link resolves (no `#`, no 404).
- Confirm contact details identical across footer, contact page, and JSON-LD.
- Mobile viewport + accessibility/contrast check; confirm every image has meaningful alt.
- Verify no image in `/public/images` exceeds ~300KB; stock images removed.

Definition of done (brief, end of step 5): five finished pages · zero placeholders · real before/after photography · 2–3 project stories · accreditations visible · Jobs Plus on the homepage · works on a phone · every image described · every link live.